

ETHAN (TAEHOON) LEE

ethantlee21@gmail.com · thdxg.dev

Dear Hiring Manager,

Since choosing software engineering as my career, I have been searching for my niche in the industry. I began at the top of the stack. I designed UIs and published a research paper on human-computer interaction. Building web interfaces intrigued me to build the backend and data layer, where I designed APIs and implemented auth and caching. My internship at a cloud infrastructure team in Summer 2025 was an enlightening experience where I solved problems at scale with cloud-native technologies. Fallen in love with Kubernetes and its open-source community, I architected my own Kubernetes cluster to deploy personal projects and contributed upstream to Kubernetes, Next.js, and Echo framework. I went further down to work closely to the metal and operating system, as I entered CMU's master's program with a focus on distributed systems.

I've journeyed through the modern technology stack from top to bottom; I can build the frontend, backend, and the infrastructure to run them on. Counterproductively to my niche-searching, there wasn't a part that I didn't enjoy learning or building. Each layer of the stack came with different problems but taught the same lesson: there's always more than what I know. In today's world, maybe what I need is the passion and vision, not a niche.

I'm drawn to Amperesand because the software spans the same distance I've been walking, from real-time control close to the hardware up to the dashboards an operator reads to understand what the hardware just did. My breadth has always felt like indecision, but this is a team where the frontend engineer and the firmware engineer have to agree on what a number means, and I've spent the last year building the observability layer that makes that agreement possible. I want to work where the system I'm instrumenting is a physical one and a wrong reading has consequences beyond a dashboard. Being in the lab five days a week is part of the appeal, since I learn fastest when I can see the thing I'm writing software for.

I distinguish myself as a disciplined and curious learner with a breadth of engineering experience. Being a Software Intern at Amperesand is an opportunity that I am ready to make the most out of, and I hope my qualities include what you are looking for.

Sincerely,

Ethan (Taehoon) Lee